

Forgive for Freedom

By : Angel/Putri

Gr.10 – Cornerstone Global Academy

The air inside the Leap Castle did not just feel cold, but it felt heavy, thick with the stench of old stones and unforgotten blood.

“Look bro, the EMF is always spiking hard right near the altar stairs,” Samuel whispered, adjusting the camera he’s holding. His breath slow, blossoming into a faint white mist under the beam of Colbrock’s flashlight.

Colbrock took slow careful steps to the altar at the chapel. History called it the Bloody Chapel, but standing in the dark, surrounded by the skeletal remnants of medieval masonry, the name felt less like a title and more like a warning.

“We’re standing where it happened, man,” Colbrock murmured quietly, looking around as he walked towards the ruined stone altar. “The O’Carroll family, Teige and Thaddeus.”

According to the local legend, the two brothers had a merciless rivalry for the title of Chieftain. Their rivalry reached its absolute limit when Thaddeus gave Teige, his brother, an insult. In Ireland, starting a religious service without the presence of the primary military leader or rival claimant was a public display of disrespect and rejection of his authority.

But that day, Thaddeus as the priest of the kingdom, decided to start the holy rites without waiting for his brother, who's a soldier.

When Teige finally arrived and realized that the holy rites had started without him, he flew into a blind, vengeful rage. He climbed the spiral staircase, stormed into the chapel room, and plunged his sword into Thaddeus’s back right at the altar.

That tragedy made both Thaddeus and Teige known to still haunt the Leap Castle, both keeping their guilt and regret with themselves, not resting in peace, while being trapped there together.

“Is there anyone here with us?” Samuel asked, using the spirit box. The device started sweeping through static radio frequencies at high speed, generating a rhythmic ‘ch-ch-ch-ch’ sound. “We aren’t here to disrespect your home, we just wanted to hear your story.”

For a long moment, it was all quiet with a bit of tapping noises from the corner of the chapel room. Then, the temperature dropped very quickly. The static suddenly cut out, replaced by a sudden, heavy silence that pressed against their ears.

“...Get out..” A voice, low, rasping, and drenched in medieval Irish accent.

Samuel and Colbrock immediately look at each other, Colbrock is the one that talked first. “Who was that? Hello?” He said, expecting a reply.

One minute, two minutes, three minutes.. No reply at all.

Colbrock took out some other devices, such as catballs, REM-Pod, and music box. After that, he set everything up, then he said “Hey, whoever that is, please interact with one of these devices that I just set up. You can just touch it or stand next to it.”

A soft, tragic wind hummed through the cold air, then suddenly the REM-Pod went on, signalling that someone is there with Samuel and Colbrock.

“I can't get out,” The spirit box suddenly made a whole sentence which made Samuel and Colbrock jump in surprise, that was too sudden.

Samuel fixed the camera, then he asked “Tell us your name, are you stuck here?” Not long after that, someone replied from the spirit box, “Yes.” That short yes gave Samuel goosebumps.

“Sam, let’s just do it.” Colbrock murmured, as he prepared for the estes method. Colbrock pulled the thick black sleep mask over Samuel’s eyes and handed him the heavy noise-cancelling headphones. They were trying the Estes Method – a sensory deprivation setup designed to cut out any chance of faking or guessing.

Samuel sat on a chair, then started to drift out from reality. He's starting to focus, and trying so hard to get answers from the spirit box connected to his headphones.

"What happened to you? Who are you?" Colbrock asked. "Thaddeus," Sam replied, the air around them turned colder. A few tapping noises were heard again from the stairs. Suddenly.. "and Teige," Both of them are here.

"I, Thaddeus, am trapped because I died with curses on my lips," Samuel continued, his ghostly voice trembling with centuries of pain, trying his best to communicate using his energy. "Teige, I spent my last breath damning you to hell instead of offering grace. I failed my vows. I failed you."

"The blood on my hands weighs heavier than the stones of this keep, I killed my own flesh." Samuel continued, a message from Teige this time.

A sharp, heavy pang struck Colbrock's chest as he listened to Thaddeus. Neither ghost was holding onto hatred anymore, they were suffocating under four hundred years of crushing guilt. Teige couldn't forgive himself for the murder, and Thaddeus couldn't forgive himself for disrespecting and dying in hatred.

Colbrock understood the situation right away, he then explained. "You've both been dead for four centuries. The clan is gone. The castle is a ruin. Holding onto this guilt isn't punishment anymore, it's a cycle neither of you can break alone. You have to forgive each other, and you have to forgive yourselves. Just like in Colossians 3:13 'Bear with each other and forgive one another if any of you has a grievance against someone. Forgive as the Lord forgave you.'"

Silence stretched across the chapel. The wind outside howled through the arched windows, but inside, the heavy static on the spirit box Sam's using suddenly fell completely silent, which made Samuel a bit confused.

"I am sorry, Thaddeus. I was blinded by power." Teige said through Samuel. "And I forgive you, Teige. Rest now. Let us both rest in peace." Thaddeus replied.

Colbrock felt touched by the conversation, he then asked "You both forgave each other, right? Just now?" ...No answer. Colbrock then tapped onto Samuel's

shoulder to signal that their estes method is done, and they're about to evaluate the things that had happened.

Colbrock explained that he talked with both Thaddeus and Teige, about their story, their mistakes and regrets. He also explains about how it ends, how Thaddeus and Teige decided to just let it all free, and about how He told the two brothers a Bible verse about forgiving each other.

Samuel felt the same thing as Colbrock – touched, saddened, but also relieved, and happy that the two brothers finally forgave each other after four centuries.

The REM-Pod gave one final, soft chime as a sudden warmth washed through the freezing room. The room went completely still, leaving only the quiet hum of the night air. The Bloody Chapel was finally quiet again.

“See man? Forgiving one another is important, because if we don’t forgive people, we would just still be pressured by the anger, guilt, and sadness towards those people.” Colbrock said to Samuel as they packed things up, and went back to their car.

Samuel sighed, “This was the best night ever, we made the two rival-brothers forgive each other, and now they could finally rest in peace.” Colbrock nodded, agreeing. “Mhm, yeah right.”

Samuel started the car, then they drove away, the Castle slowly gone. They let the memory of the night sink into reflection to themselves.